THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 8: **Follow That Dream; Step Up to the Challenge** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The letter's most significant claim is that: 1

(a) dreams are earned through sustained commitment and help from others
(b) dreams are childish
(c) dreams need no work
(d) dreams are luck

2. In the poem, the metaphor of comfort as a trap implies that: 1

(a) comfort is cheap **(b)** safety may cost us growth
(c) comfort is evil **(d)** comfort is rare

3. Choose the correct use of a participle phrase: 1

(a) Counted the cost, Ming have begun.
(b) Having counted the cost, Ming began her journey.
(c) Ming counted the cost having began.
(d) Having count the cost, Ming began.

4. Which statement exposes a limitation of the mother's advice? 1

(a) it assumes the dreamer has access to support and resources
(b) it is a poem
(c) it is too short
(d) it is rude

5. The poem's insistence on 'stepping up' reflects: 1

(a) a belief in luck **(b)** fear of failure
(c) a belief that courage is a choice **(d)** boredom

6. Choose the correct reported speech: Mother said, 'Had I known your plan, I would have helped.' 1

(a) Mother said I would have helped.
(b) Mother said that had she known my plan, she would have helped.
(c) Mother said had I known my plan, I helped.
(d) Mother said she knows my plan.

7. The mother's refusal to promise success is a sign of: 1

(a) fear **(b)** honest care **(c)** dislike **(d)** neglect

8. Which reading of the poem is least supported? 1

(a) The first step is hard **(b)** Avoid all challenges
(c) Belief matters **(d)** Courage grows by acting

9. The word 'tenacity' is closest in meaning to: 1

(a) weakness **(b)** speed **(c)** joy **(d)** persistence

10. The phrase 'count the cost' contains an economic metaphor which suggests: 1

(a) dreams are cheap **(b)** dreams are bought
(c) dreams must be 'paid for' with effort **(d)** dreams have no price

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Evaluate the claim that the mother's letter is more realistic than idealistic. 2

12. How does the letter model good communication? 2

13. How does the poem's directness suit its message? 2

14. How does the mother handle the possibility of Ming's failure? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Critically evaluate the idea that 'success is the result of sacrifice'. 3

16. Explain why the poem uses simple vocabulary to convey a serious theme. 3

17. Rewrite with inversion: 'She had barely started when problems arose.' 3

OR

How does the letter anticipate and answer possible objections to dreaming? 3

18. Analyse the poem's use of metaphor. 3

OR

Explain the idiom 'to burn the midnight oil' with reference to the letter. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'The letter treats dreams as a contract between hope and effort.' Discuss. 5

OR

Compare the prose letter and the poem as vehicles for the same message. 5

20. Critically analyse the mother's approach to mentoring. 5

OR

Write a speech for a career guidance day on 'Follow your dream, with your eyes open'. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks